[Metric]
A-A-2960
October 25, 1995

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
MARKER, TUBE TYPE, PERMANENT
(SOLVENT-BASED INK)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. Scope: This Commercial Item Description covers tube type, valve action, bullet shaped, **(Medium Line)** quick-drying solvent-based, permanent ink markers suitable for marking on both porous and non-porous surfaces. Marks are opaque and glossy.

2. Classification:

Type: I. Individual Markers
II. 6 Marker Set
III. 12 Marker Set

3. Salient Characteristics:

3.1 The marker shall be constructed so as to prevent evaporation and leakage of the ink and shall be equipped with a protective cap. The cap or body shall be colored, or display a colored marking to indicate the color of ink content.

3.2 The ink shall be fed to the nib by valve action and shall be capable of writing on the following surfaces: Glass, metal, wood, rubber, stone, plastic, paper, vinyl, leather, felt, and canvas.

3.3 Metal or plastic used shall be of a material appropriate for the intended purpose and when used externally they shall be suitable for coating as a decorative protective finish.

3.4 The writing nib shall be bullet shaped (medium size) with a diameter of 4.6 cm (1.8 inch) ± .5 cm (.5 inch) and will be provided in the following colors or as specified in paragraph 7.2 of this commercial item description: **Type I** Individual colors, **Type II** Black, Red, Blue, Green, Yellow, and White; **Type III** Black, Red, Blue, Green, Lt. Blue, Pink, Yellow, Orange, Violet, White, Silver, and Gold.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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3.5 The manufacturer's name or trademark shall be exhibited on each marker. Placement of these permanent markings shall be at the option of the manufacturer, provided they are prominently displayed.

3.6 The overall length of the marker shall be 13.9 cm ± .2 cm and the width shall be 1.6 cm ± .2 cm (.6 inch ± .08 inch). The nib shall be made of felt or fiber or materials which are commercially acceptable. The marker shall have a maximum write-out distance of 182880.6 mm (600 ft) with a minimum of 106680.4 mm (350 ft).

3.7 Shelf Life. The items shall be able to meet all the requirements of this specification from the time of delivery to a minimum of 18 months in storage under normal conditions. Suppliers shall replace, without cost to the government, all markers failing to meet this requirement.

3.8 Workmanship. The marker shall be free from defects or imperfections of manufacture which may affect their durability, appearance, serviceability or which may present a hazard to the user.

4. Regulatory Requirements:

The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4.1 Toxicity. The use of any toxic substance must be in accordance with all applicable federal statutes. The use of any known carcinogens as ingredients is prohibited. The harmful substances shall be defined as poison and injurious substances as designated in Fed. Std. 313. The vendor shall prepare a certification that the inks conforms to the above requirements.

4.2 Labeling. Containers shall be labeled to comply with the Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations, 16 code of Federal Regulations, Part 1500.

4.3 Material Safety Data Sheets. Safety data sheets shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

5. Quality Assurance Requirements:

5.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and therefore as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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5.2 Examination and Testing.

5.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC Techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

5.2.2 End item inspection / testing may be used by the offerer or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. In process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing.

5.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection / test shall be required. The sample unit for this item shall be one marker or marking set. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

5.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual, dimensional, and performance testing shall testing shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

5.3 Performance Tests: Unless otherwise specified, the tests shall be conducted in an atmosphere of 23°C ± 1.1° C (73.5 F ± 2° F) and at a relative humidity of 50% ± 4%. Tests involving writing, shall be conducted on the following surfaces: melamine, porcelain, glass, smooth metal or transparencies with the markers held at an angle approximately 50° from the horizontal and with a writing pressure so that the markings are clearly visible. The write-out test shall continue until the marker has reached the minimum write-out distance.

5.3.1 Drying Time. Write a five-letter word (on one of the surfaces outlined in paragraph 4.3) utilizing an sample marker. Allow to dry for 5 seconds. The markings shall not smear or smudge.

5.3.2 Write-Out Test. Write a five-letter word (on one of the surfaces outlined in paragraph 4.3) utilizing an sample marker. Allow to dry for 5 seconds. The marker shall produce solid continuous lines free from breaks, splits, separations, uneven concentrations with bright, highly visible markings. The markers reservoir shall be weighed with ink and then when empty. The fill shall weigh between 1.5 - 2 grams.

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6. Packaging:

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

7. Notes:

7.1 Applicable Documents. Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

7.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

7.1.2 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2, Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

7.1.3 Federal Standards and Specifications may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at 490 L'Enfant Plaza, SW Washington DC 20407.

7.2 Ordering Information. Purchaser should select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents.

A. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
B. Purchasers shall specify type and color of marker or set desired.
C. Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified.
D. Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment, if other than required.
E. Purchasers shall specify identification marking, if other than required.
F. Purchasers shall specify if bar code marking is not required.
G. Purchasers should specify palletization, if required.
H. MSD's required, in addition to those required by FED-STD-313.

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7.2 National Stock Number Listing.

Marker, Tube Type

7520-01-207-4139
7520-01-207-4160
7520-01-207-4161
7520-01-207-4165
7520-01-207-4166
7520-01-238-8043
7520-01-343-4416

Marker, Tube Type Set

7520-01-207-4167
7520-01-207-4168

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an interest in this commercial item description.

PREPARING ACTIVITY
GSA-FSS

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